Shira Z. Carmel

Composer · Singer · Songwriter

NEW SINGLE

Four Boys Maybe Five

A poem by Tal Nitzán · Music by Shira Z. Carmel



A stark chamber song for voice, cello, baritone saxophone and piano that leaves Tal Nitzán’s chilling poem exposed and confronts listeners with motherhood, moral responsibility and the blurred line between victim and perpetrator.

LISTEN TO THE SONG: too.fm/fbmf
Press Download With Password (WAV file)

SHORT BIO

Shira Z. Carmel is a Jerusalem-born, Melbourne-based composer, singer and songwriter. Performing in English, Hebrew and Yiddish, she moves between jazz, cabaret, folk, alternative pop and experimental song, often setting poetry to music. Her work spans film, radio, interdisciplinary art, television and commercials; her projects have toured internationally. Carmel's new single, “Four Boys Maybe Five,” sets a chilling poem by Tal Nitzán for voice, cello, baritone saxophone and piano. She holds a degree in vocal performance from the Multidisciplinary Department of the Jerusalem Academy of Music and Dance. In 2023, she received the Neve Schechter and Rabinovich Foundation Award for Original Israeli Creation.

THE SONG

Four Boys Maybe Five

Poem by Tal Nitzán (originally in Hebrew)
English-language poem published in The Guardian
Recorded and produced in Melbourne

Four boys, maybe five, are shaking a car,
their faces distorted by the thrill of destruction.
Beneath its wheels lies an abyss.
Inside the car is your son.
The car tilts.
Desolation all around,
desolation within you and without trying
you already know,
no voice will emerge from your throat.
What will you do?

Four boys, maybe five, are shaking a car.
Under its wheels lies an abyss.
The boy in the car is not your son.
Your son is outside with them,
his face distorted by the
thrill of destruction.
What will you do

SONG CREDITS

Music, voice, arrangement, production:	Shira Z. Carmel
Cello and cello solo:	Vincent Ward
Baritone saxophone:	Gideon Brazil
Piano:	Adrian Banner
Recording, co-production:	Dan Shani at Evoke Sounds studios Melbourne

ABOUT THE ARTIST

Long bio

For more than two decades, Israeli-born and Melbourne-based artist Shira Z. Carmel has made songs that move between alternative pop, jazz, cabaret, folk and experimental music. A composer, singer and songwriter, she works in Hebrew, English and Yiddish, and has built a varied body of work through vocal ensembles, jazz projects, theatrical song and collaborations across the arts. Her music often interweaves political and humanist themes, drawing on her lifelong work as an activist and volunteer.

Shira was a founding member, songwriter and co-arranger of the vocal trio The Hazelnuts, which toured internationally. Other projects include the Shira Z. Carmel Quartet, her brass band Shira Z. Carmel and her Brasserie, the Yiddish experimental duo The Technicalities, and “Infinity and One — Lullabies for Mothers,” a project setting poetry about motherhood to music. Her work has also appeared in film, television, radio and commercials.

She holds a degree in vocal performance from the Multidisciplinary Department of the Jerusalem Academy of Music and Dance. In 2023, she received the Neve Schechter and Rabinovich Foundation Award for Original Israeli Creation.

Her latest single, “Four Boys Maybe Five,” sets a poem by Tal Nitzán in a minimal chamber arrangement for voice, cello, baritone saxophone and piano. The poem’s two mirrored scenes ask a parent to imagine both sides of a violent encounter. Recorded and produced in Melbourne, the song arrives from a distance that offers space to listen closely without looking away.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Shira Z. Carmel and her Brasserie	Horn-driven songs for an eight-piece ensemble
Infinity and One — Lullabies for Mothers	Hebrew motherhood-song project
The Hazelnuts	Vocal trio · founding member, songwriter and co-arranger · international touring
The Technicalities	Yiddish experimental duo
Shira Z. Carmel Quartet	Original songs across jazz, alternative pop and cabaret

MEDIA & LINKS

LISTEN	Spotify · Apple Music · Bandcamp · Infinity and One
WATCH	Brasserie · The Hazelnuts · Shira Z. Quartet · The Technicalities
PHOTOS	High-resolution artist portrait and official single artwork included in the online EPK, with direct downloads.
CONTACT	contact@shiracarmel.com · Instagram · Facebook · YouTube
MANAGEMENT	AED Artist Management · jeff@aedam.com.au · aedam.com.au